

Climate Action

Progress Report 2025

MALTA

Country profile

January 2026



This country profile supports and complement the assessments of the Climate Action Progress Report 2025. It is based on data reported by the EU Member States. It does not replace formal progress assessments.

EUROPEAN COMMISSION

Directorate-General for Climate Action

Directorate A — Strategy, Analysis and Planning

Unit A.2 — Foresight, Economic Analysis & Modelling

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1. Key highlights

- In 2024, net GHG emissions in Malta were 2.2 MtCO₂-eq, 3.1% lower compared to 2023.
- Net GHG emissions (i.e. including LULUCF) in 2024 were 17% lower than 1990 levels.
- Most of the emissions are from the international maritime and aviation sector (77%), followed by the domestic transport sector (8%).
- By 2024, emissions in the sectors covered by the EU ETS were down by 63% against 2005 levels.
- Emissions covered by the Effort Sharing Regulation decreased by 0.8% compared to 2023.
- Malta is projected to having excess ESR emissions in the years 2026-2030.
- In 2024 LULUCF net emissions were 3.4 KtCO₂-eq, an increase of 2.4 KtCO₂-eq compared to 2023.
- Latest LULUCF projections for Malta are broadly in line with the estimated 2030 target.
- 69% of the Recovery and Resilience Plan and 32% of cohesion policy funds are allocated to climate action.

2. Greenhouse gas emissions

In 2024, approximated domestic greenhouse gas (GHG) net emissions in Malta were 2.2 MtCO₂-eq, 3.1% lower compared to 2023 and 2% above pre-pandemic levels. Overall, net domestic emissions, including the Land Use, Land Use Change and Forestry (LULUCF) sector, were 17% lower than 1990 levels, and 17% lower when LULUCF is excluded.

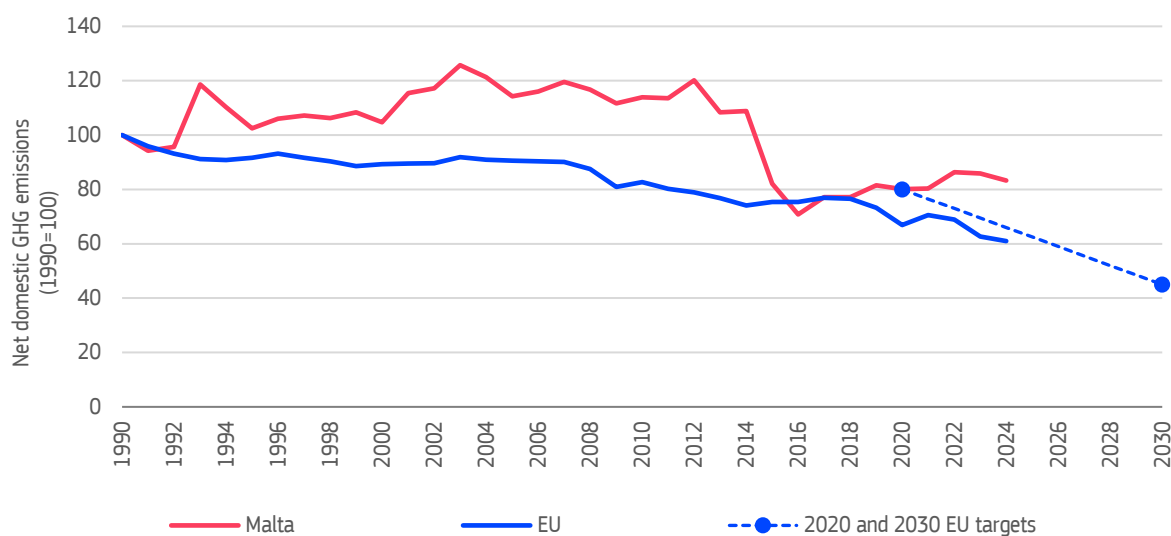
Table 1: Total domestic GHG emissions

	MtCO ₂ -eq	% change	% average annual change		
	1990	1990-2024	1990-2005	2005-2023	2023-2024
Malta	3	-17%	0.9%	-1.6%	-3.2%
EU-27	4 873	-38%	-0.5%	-2.1%	-2.1%

Table 2: Total net domestic GHG emissions (including LULUCF)

	MtCO ₂ -eq	% change	% average annual change		
	1990	1990-2024	1990-2005	2005-2023	2023-2024
Malta	3	-17%	0.9%	-1.6%	-3.1%
EU-27	4 635	-39%	-0.7%	-2.0%	-2.8%

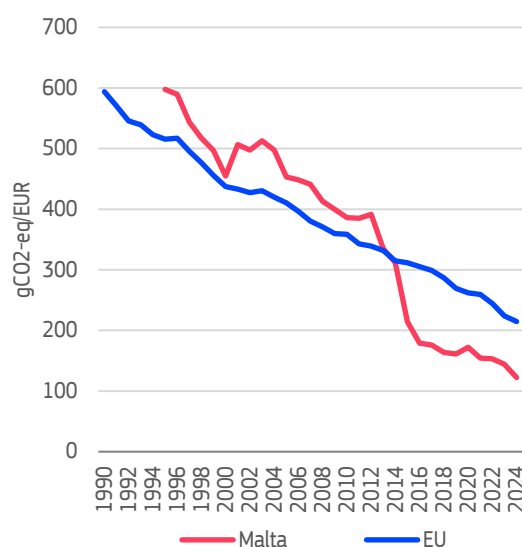
Figure 1: Net domestic GHG emissions 1990-2030



Note: GHG emissions and removals for 1990-2023 are based on data submitted by EU Member States to the UNFCCC under Regulation (EU) No 525/2013. GHG emissions for 2024 are based on approximated GHG inventories.

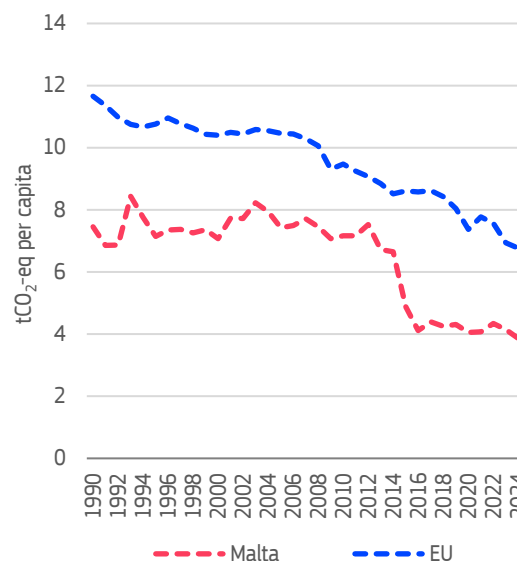
In 2024, net GHG emissions per capita in Malta were 3.9 tonnes of CO₂ equivalent, below the EU average of 6.8 tCO₂-eq. In the same year, the GHG intensity of GDP (i.e. net GHG emissions over GDP) was 122 gCO₂-eq/EUR, below the EU average of 215 gCO₂-eq/EUR.

Figure 2: GHG intensity of GDP (1990-2023)



Note: Total net GHG emissions, including LULUCF and excluding international aviation. GHG inventory 1990-2023 and approximated GHG inventory 2024 (EEA). Real GDP in 2015-prices (Eurostat).

Figure 3: GHG emissions per capita (1990-2023)



Note: Total net GHG emissions, including LULUCF and excluding international aviation. GHG inventory 1990-2023 and approximated GHG inventory 2024 (EEA). Population (Eurostat).

In 2025, Malta submitted GHG projections. Under the existing policy scenario (WEM) they point to a decrease in net GHG emissions (including LULUCF) of 26% by 2030 and to a decrease of 43% by 2050, compared to 1990. With additional measures (WAM), projected changes are -31% and -37% for the same respective years.

By comparing the cumulative projected net GHG emissions between 2024 and 2050 with a linear trajectory to climate neutrality by 2050, Malta shows an overshoot of 70% (i.e. cumulative projected emissions are higher than those from a linear trajectory).

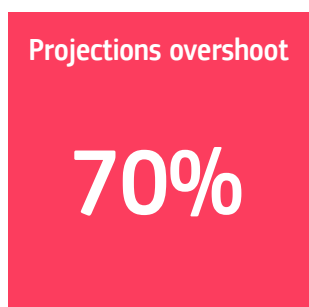
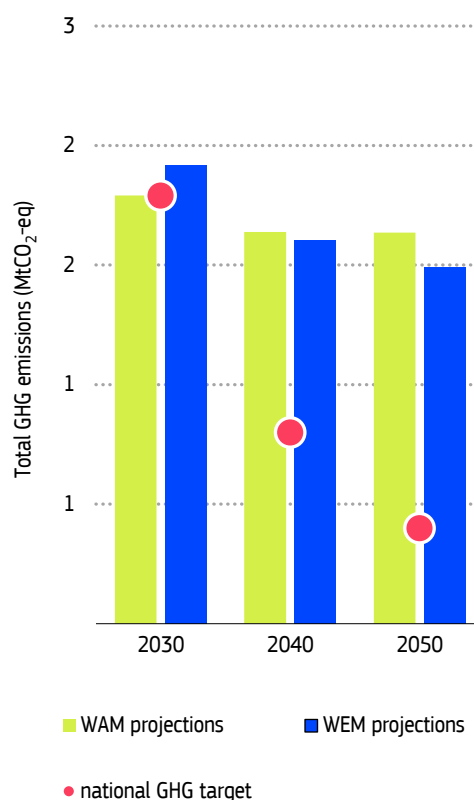
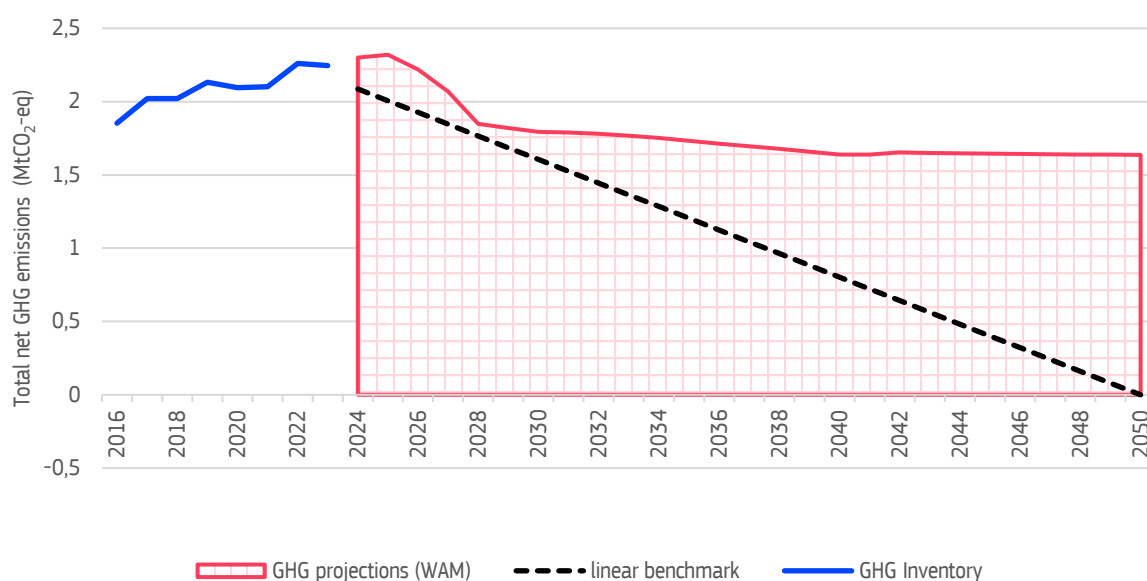


Figure 4: Projections and national GHG target



Note: (1) GHG emission projections as submitted by EU Member States in March 2025. (2) WEM = with existing measures; WAM = with existing and additional measures. (3) The national GHG targets are from Member States' submissions of NECP progress reports (Annex I, Table 1). Missing data are replaced by other available reported information.

Figure 5: Projected cumulative net GHG emissions vs cumulative emissions of a linear trajectory to climate neutrality between 2023 and 2050



Note: The overshoot metric compares cumulative projected net GHG emissions under the WAM scenario (including LULUCF) with cumulative emissions underlying a linear trajectory from 2024 emissions levels to zero by 2050.

3. Greenhouse gas emissions by sector

In 2024, the highest contribution to GHG emissions in Malta came from the emissions from fuel use in international maritime and aviation transport (77%, also known as international bunker fuels), followed by the domestic transport sector (8%) and the energy sector (8%).

Between 2005 and 2024, the sectors which contributed the most to the change in net GHG emissions (i.e. +75%) were international maritime and aviation, for which emissions increased by 202%, and energy, where, conversely, emissions fell by 63%.

Figure 6: GHG emissions by sector

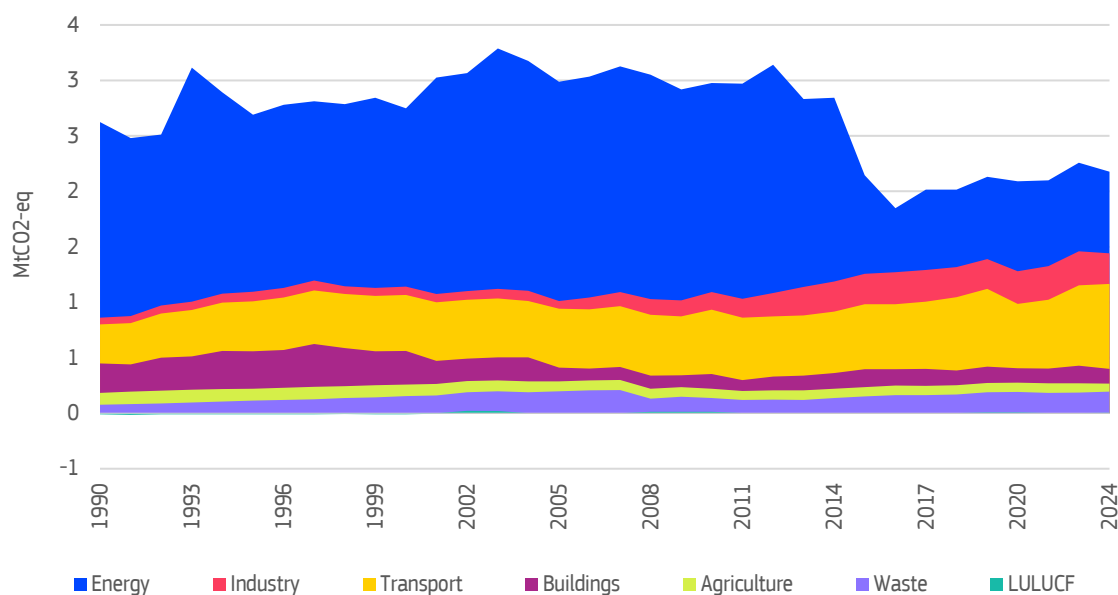


Table 3: GHG emissions by sector

Sector	Change	Average annual change			EU
	1990-2024	1990-2005	2005-2023	2023-2024	2023-2024
Energy	-58.2%	0.8%	-4.9%	-7.8%	-8.7%
Industry	356%	0.9%	7.9%	0.7%	0.4%
Transport	118.3%	2.8%	2.1%	0.2%	0.7%
Buildings	-50%	-5.0%	0.6%	-3.8%	-0.4%
Agriculture	-34.6%	-1.2%	-0.5%	-15.0%	-1.2%
Waste	155%	6.6%	-0.4%	4.8%	-0.4%
LULUCF	0.0*	0.0*	0.0*	0.0*	-13
Intern. aviation and maritime	559%	5.3%	6.7%	-6.6%	2.4%

Notes: *LULUCF shows absolute change and average absolute annual change in MtCO₂-eq. Negative values indicate a reduction of net emissions or an increase in net removals. (1) Energy sector refers to electricity and heat production and petroleum refining. (2) Industry includes fuel combustion in manufacturing and construction and emissions in industrial processes and product use. (3) Buildings include emissions from energy use in residential and tertiary buildings, and energy use in agriculture and fishery sectors. (4) Emissions from fuel used for international aviation and maritime transport (also known as international bunker fuels) are reported in the GHG inventory as memo item. they are not included in the total GHG emissions.

4. Emissions under the EU Emissions Trading System (ETS)

The EU ETS is an EU-wide market instrument to provide an incentive for emission reductions and transformative investments in the covered sectors. This means that it is largely the market that determines where in the EU the emission reductions take place, outside the control of Member States. However, Member States may adopt complementary (sectoral) policies in addition to the ETS's carbon price signal.

In 2024, stationary installations (4 power generation and manufacturing industries) in Malta emitted 0.7 MtCO₂-eq (equal to 33% of total GHG emissions in Malta). This was 7.6% lower compared to 2023 and similar to 2019, the pre-pandemic levels. By 2024, emissions from stationary installations were down by 57% against the 2013 level (i.e. - 63% to the 2005 level). Aviation emissions covered by the EU ETS were 54.3% higher compared to 2023 and 410% above the 2019 pre-pandemic level.

Figure 7: Verified ETS emissions by sector

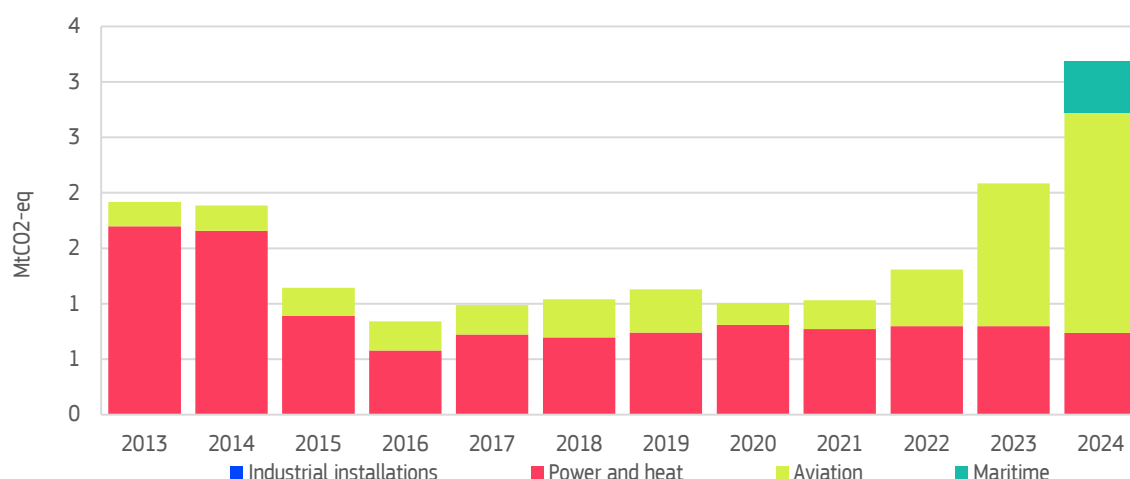


Table 4: Verified ETS emissions by sector

MtCO ₂ -eq	2013	2023	2024
Power & heat installations	1.7	0.8	0.7
% change since 2013	-	-53.0%	-56.6%
Industrial installations	No emissions	No emissions	No emissions
% change since 2013	-	-	-
Aviation (*)	0.22	1.29	1.99
% change since 2013	-	485.5%	803.5%
Maritime (**)			0.46

Notes: (*) ETS emissions from aviation include flights within the European Economic Area (EEA) and outgoing flights to Switzerland and to the UK. (**) In 2024, maritime transport emissions were included in the EU ETS for the first time.

In parallel, Malta has raised over EUR 0.23 billion in auction revenues since 2013 (EUR 44 million in 2024), available for further climate action and energy transformation. Malta reported that an average of 111% of revenues was spent for climate and energy purposes over the same period.

Table 5: Revenue generated by EU Member States from the auctioning of ETS allowances in 2023 and 2024 to be spent on climate and energy-related purposes (EUR million), the share reported as disbursed (%) and a summary of revenue usage and purposes

 Malta		Total percentage disbursed up to the year indicated	
Year of generation of revenues	Revenues to be spent on the purposes of Art. 10(3) (EUR million)	2023	2024
2023	44.6	100%	100% previously
2024	44.2	x	100%
Revenue usage: All of the 2024 revenue to be spent for the purposes of Article 10(3) was reported as disbursed. Revenues are not earmarked.			
Purpose(s) with the largest use of ETS revenue in 2024:			
- The Ministry for Transport, Infrastructure and Public Works funded Malta Transport Incentive Programme Electric Vehicle Grants (MTIP EV Grants) with EUR 22.0 million, providing purchase and scrappage subsidies to accelerate electric vehicle adoption. - EUR 20.3 million for Malta's scheme administered by the Regulator for Energy and Water Services (ARMS), offering guaranteed fixed rates to small-scale renewable electricity producers—such as solar, biogas, and hydro, for grid injection. - ARMS Malta also funded the Eco-reduction scheme which provides electricity tariff discounts to incentivize energy efficiency and reward the lowest-emitting consumers, with EUR 7.8 million.			

5. Emissions in effort sharing sectors (ESR)

In 2024, approximated emissions under the Effort Sharing Regulation (ESR), covering transport, buildings, agriculture, waste and small industry, were 66% of total emissions in Malta, in line with the EU ESR emissions' share in total EU emissions.

These ESR emissions in Malta were 1 MtCO₂-eq, 0.8% lower than in 2023, but 3.6% above 2019, the pre-pandemic level.

Figure 10: Share of ESR and ETS emissions

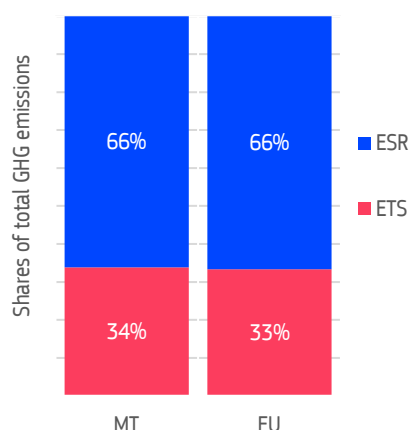
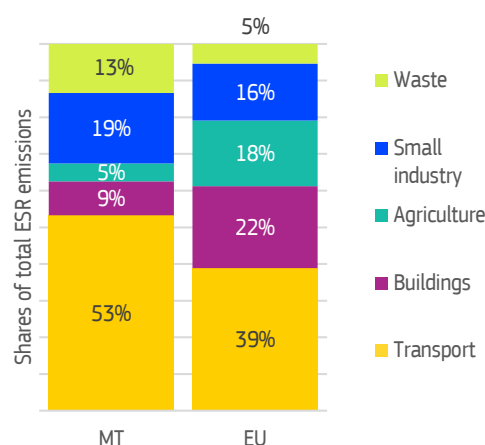


Figure 11: ESR emissions by sector (2024)



Notes: (1) Small industry includes emissions from energy industries, manufacturing and construction, and industrial processes, that do not fall under the EU Emission Trading System. (2) Transport includes emissions from domestic transport activities, excluding CO₂ emissions from aviation. (3) Buildings includes emissions for heating buildings under the ESR.

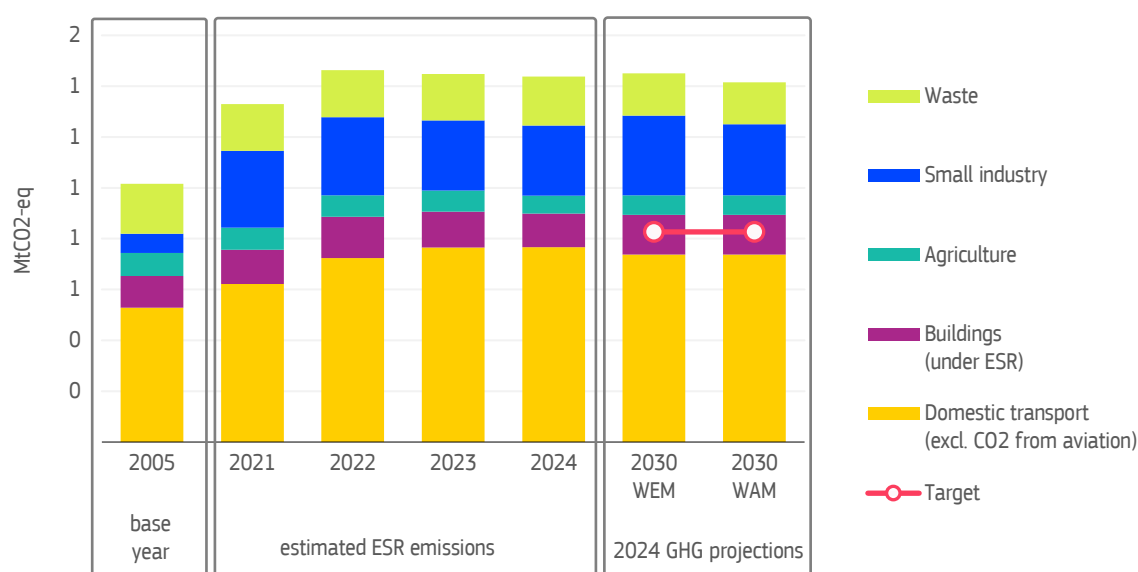
In 2024, the largest contribution to the absolute change in ESR emissions came from agriculture, for which emissions decreased by 15%, and buildings, with emissions decreasing by 6.4% compared to 2023.

In 2024, agriculture accounted for 5% of total ESR emissions in Malta, and buildings accounted for 9%.

The Effort Sharing Regulation (ESR) sets the 2030 ESR emission reduction target for Malta to 19.0%, compared to 2005 levels. Latest GHG projections submitted by Malta under the existing measures scenario (WEM) point to a 42% increase in ESR emissions by 2030 compared to 2005 levels, less ambitious than its ESR emission reduction target by 61 percentage points. Considering the impact of additional measures (WAM), projected ESR emissions point to a 30% increase, less ambitious than its ESR emission reduction target by 49 percentage points.

The Commission assesses Member States progress under the ESR over the period 2021–2030, taking into account the domestic flexibilities under the ESR and assuming Member States will implement the additional measures in their WAM projections (interactions with the LULUCF sector are not considered here). As a result, Malta is projected to having excess ESR emissions in the years 2026–2030.

Figure 12: ESR emission by sector (2005-2030)



Note: (1) 2023 ESR emissions are based on approximated inventory reports and the European Environment Agency (EEA)'s calculation of ESR emissions. The approximated emissions can, therefore, deviate from Member States' reported emissions. (2) Projections as reported by Member States under Reg. (EU) 2018/1999, compiled and checked by the EEA. (3) WEM with existing measures, WAM with existing and additional measures.

Table 6: Targets, historical and projected emissions under the effort-sharing legislation and distance to targets in percentage change from 2005 base year emissions

Member State	Target and emissions	2021	2022	2023	2024	2030 (projections WEM)	2030 (projections WAM)
Malta	Target	102%	21%	16%	11%	-19%	-19%
	Emissions	30%	43%	42%	41%	42%	30%
	Distance to target (pp)	73	-22	-25	-30	-61	-49
EU-27	Target	-12%	-15%	-18%	-21%	-40%	-40%
	Emissions	-15%	-18%	-20%	-20%	-31%	-38%
	Distance to target (pp)	3	3	2	-1	-8	-2

Table 7: Annual emissions allocations, historical and projected emissions, and distance to targets under the Effort Sharing Regulation (MtCO₂-eq) covering the period 2021–2030. Positive values indicate overachievement, negative values indicate underachievement.

Malta	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Estimated AEAs	2.1	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.1	1.2	1.1	1.0	0.9	0.8
Emissions	1.3	1.5	1.4	1.4	1.5	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.3	1.3
Distance to target	0.7	-0.2	-0.3	-0.3	-0.4	-0.2	-0.2	-0.3	-0.4	-0.5
Cumulative balance of AEAs	0.7	0.5	0.3	0.0	-0.4	-0.7	-0.9	-1.2	-1.6	-2.1

Baseline emissions 1.0 MtCO₂-eq

2005 base year emissions

Flexibility ETS flexibility 0.5 MtCO₂-eq

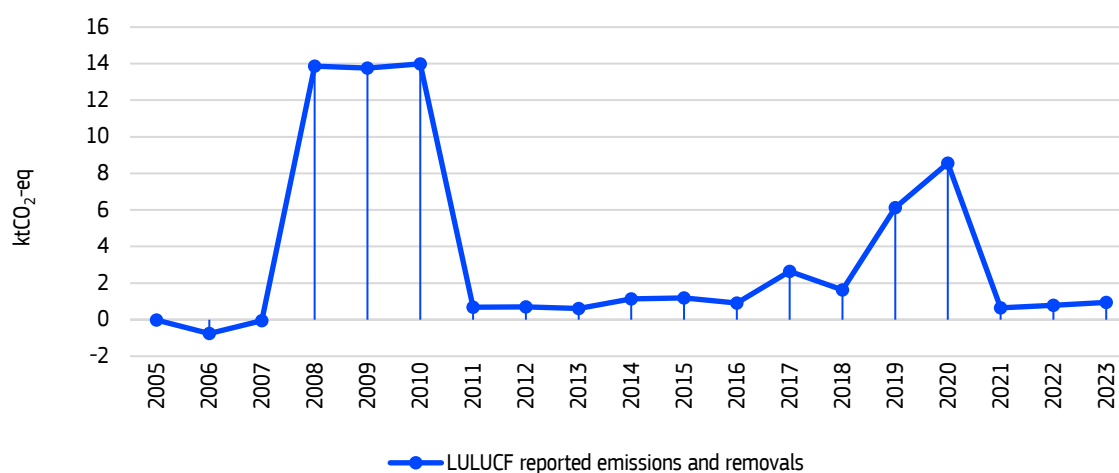
Amount of ETS flexibility as per Commission Implementing Decision 2020/2126 and available over the 10-year period 2021–2030.

Maximum LULUCF flexibility	0.0 MtCO ₂ -eq	The availability of LULUCF flexibility depends on the amount of LULUCF credits generated under the LULUCF Regulation. The use of the available LULUCF flexibility is limited to 50% of the maximum amount of LULUCF flexibility in the period 2021-2025 and 50% of the maximum amount of LULUCF flexibility in the period 2026-2030.
LULUCF debit (2021-2025)	Pursuant to Art 9(2) ESR, AEAs are reduced by the debit generated under the LULUCF Regulation in the period 2021-2025. See Chapter 4 of the Climate Action Progress Report 2025.	

6. Land use, land use change and forestry (LULUCF)

Based on final inventory data, in 2023, Malta reported net emissions of 0.95 KtCO₂-eq in the land use, land use change, and forestry sector (LULUCF). Based on approximated data, in 2024, net emissions from the LULUCF sector were 3.39 KtCO₂-eq.

Figure 13: Reported LULUCF net emissions and removals



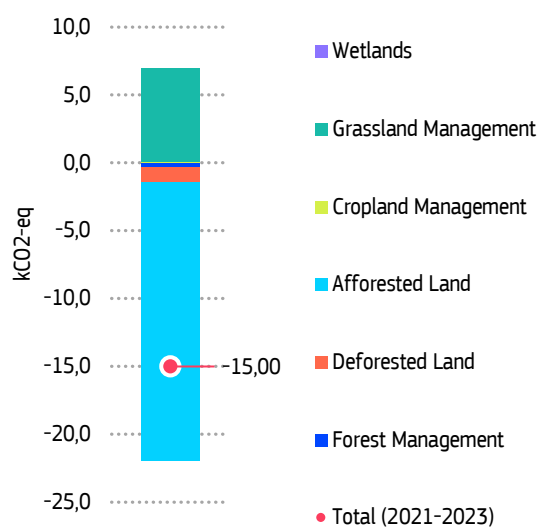
Notes: Figure shows net reported emissions and removals for the LULUCF sector. Net removals are expressed as negative numbers and net emissions as positive numbers.

With current LULUCF accounting rules – with a limited scope – applicable to the period 2021 to 2025, the provisional ‘accounted’ balance for the period 2021-2023 using the 2025 GHG inventory submission produced an accounted credit of 15 KtCO₂-eq.

Afforested Land and Grassland Management were the dominating land activities, with accounted net removals of 20.5 and accounted net emissions of 6.9 KtCO₂-eq, respectively.

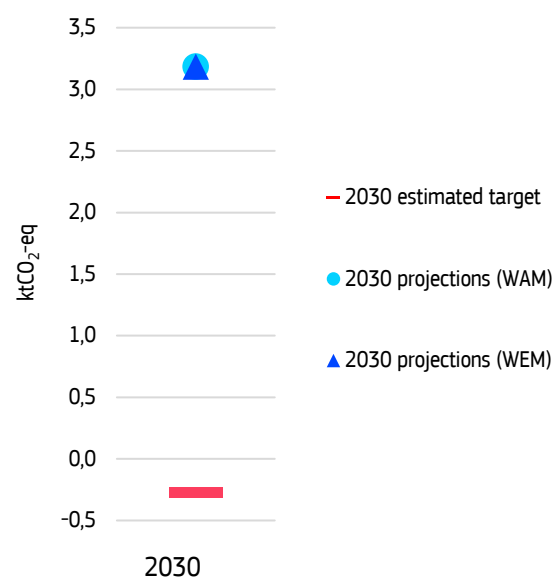
Latest LULUCF projections for Malta show net emissions in 2030 of 3.2 KtCO₂-eq with existing measures (WEM), leaving a gap of around 3.5 MtCO₂-eq to the estimated 2030 net removal target of 0.27 KtCO₂-eq. Malta did not submit projections with additional measures (WAM).

Figure 14: Period 2021-2025 with accounting rules



Note: Figure shows the accounted emissions and removals for the LULUCF sector in the period 2021-2023. Computation of the accounts per land use category, applying the standardised rules in the LULUCF Regulation (EU) 2018/841. The input data for this analysis have been extracted from the EU Greenhouse Gas Inventory Report 2025 for 1990-2023 based on final Member States' inventory submissions under the EU Governance Regulation (EU) 2018/1999.

Figure 15: Progress towards 2030 target



Note: Figure shows projected progress with existing measures (WEM) and with additional measures (WAM) in relation to the national 2030 target. The LULUCF Regulation sets out binding national 2030 targets for each Member State encompassing all emissions and removals in the LULUCF sector (Art. 4.3). The targets are specified in Annex IIa of the LULUCF Regulation. Individual targets are derived from the EU-wide target of -310 MtCO₂-eq net removals by 2030, Member States' average historic net removals from their GHG inventories for the years 2016, 2017 and 2018 and the countries' share of total EU managed land area. The gaps to the 2030 LULUCF target have been calculated taking into account the latest Member States' GHG inventories data and projections (both submitted in 2025), including a re-adjustment to take into account possible discrepancies between the inventory data and projections. As Member States continuously improve their methodologies for GHG inventory data and projections in terms of accuracy, the gap calculations are susceptible to changes in the future.

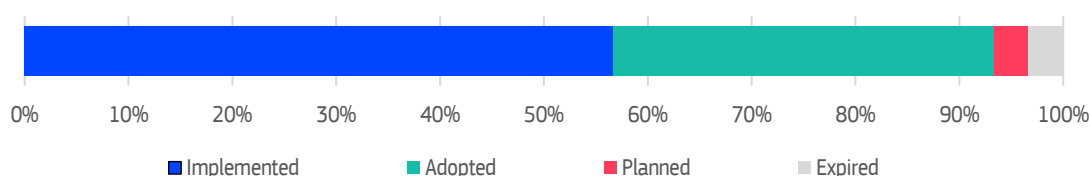


7. Policies and measures

This section uses data reported every two years by EU Member States on their national greenhouse gas policies and measures (Article 18 of the Governance of the Energy Union and Climate Action Regulation). The EEA performs specific quality checks on the submissions by Member States to ensure the accuracy of the reported information on policies and measures. Nonetheless, the analysis suffers from the lack of completeness of reported data.

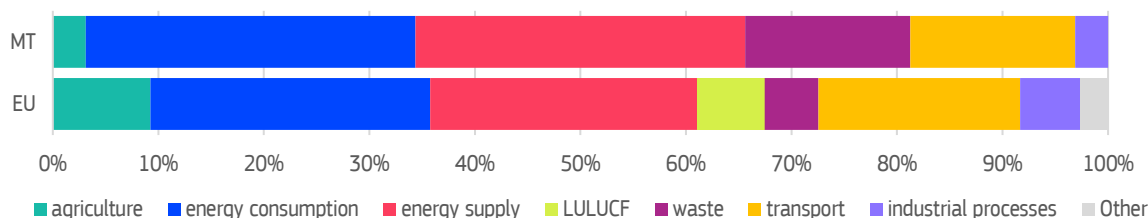
In 2025, Malta reported 30 single policies and measures, representing a decrease of 35% compared to 2023, due to grouping existing measures. As of 2025, 3% of the reported policies and measures are planned but not yet implemented (i.e. theoretically linked to the 'with additional measures' projected scenario').

Figure 16: Number of policies and measures by status

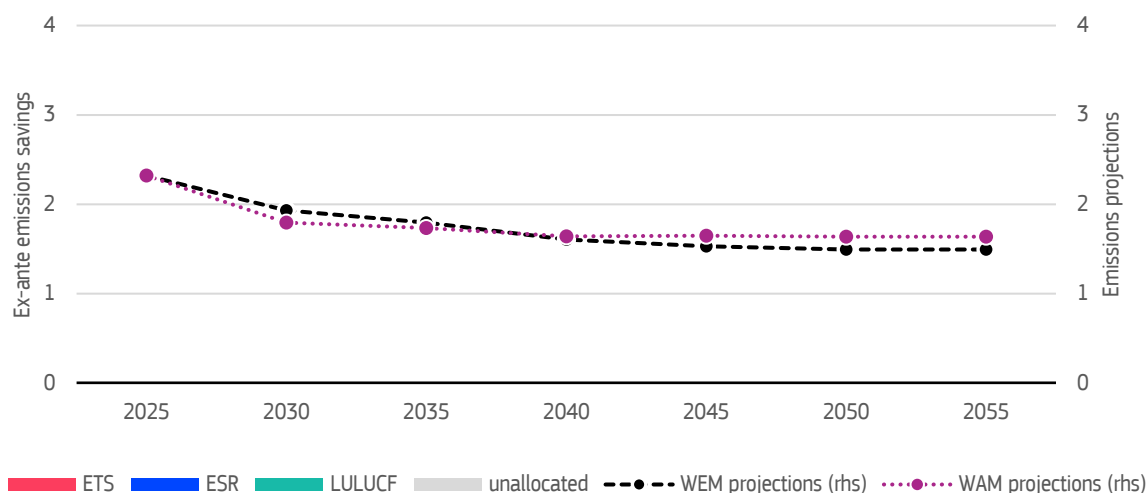


Most of the policies and measures (31%) affect emissions in energy consumption, followed by energy supply (31%).

Figure 17: Number of policies and measures by affected sector



Malta did not estimate an expected emission reduction for any of its single or group policies and measures.

Figure 18: Ex-ante emissions savings and projections (MtCO₂-eq)

Linking the reported policies and measures to GHG emission projections, which must also be reported biennially and by the same deadline, ensures that emission trends can be interpreted and explained in the context of the national policy landscape. For more information see the [ETC CM Report 2025/04](#).

More information and visualisations are available at the EEA integrated national energy and climate policies and measures [data viewer](#).

8. Climate-neutrality dashboard

	Domestic GHG net emissions (2024-2019 % change)	GHG intensity of GDP (2024)	FEC in households per capita (2023)	Projected net GHG emissions by 2030 (tonnes CO ₂ -eq per capita)	Share of gross final consumption of energy from renewable	Projected net GHG emissions by 2050 (t CO ₂ -eq per capita)	Overshoot vs. non-linear benchmark (2023-2050)	Target year for climate neutrality	Legal status
Malta	2%	123	206	3.0	15%	2.2	49%	2050	In policy document
EU-27	-17%	200	511	4.5	25%	2.1	24%	2050	In law
Changes compared to the 2024 edition. The icons inform whether the indicator has improved (green ●), has remained broadly stable (yellow ●) or has worsened (red ●) compared to the 2024 edition.									
Malta	●	●	●	●	●	●	●		
EU-27	●	●	●	●	●	●	●		

Notes: The table above represents an extract of the Climate Neutrality Dashboard as reported in the staff working document accompanying the [Climate Action Progress Reports 2025](#). (1) GHG intensity of GDP (gCO₂-eq/EUR2015) uses net GHG emissions (i.e. including LULUCF and excluding international aviation). Real GDP and population data from Eurostat. Final energy consumption in household per capita is from Eurostat [sdg_07_20] and are in Kilogram of oil equivalent (KGOE). (2) GHG emission projections as submitted in 2025 by Member States under Art. 18 of the Governance Regulation considering additional measures (WAM). EU Population in 2050 is based on the latest Eurostat population projections. Agriculture and forest land are based on the Eurostat land use statistics. (3) The overshoot against a non-

linear indicative benchmark compares the cumulative projected GHG emissions (excluding LULUCF) with an indicative pathway to climate neutrality based on the scenarios proposed by the European Scientific Advisory Board on Climate Change, and then distributed across Member States according to the country's share of EU emissions in the core policy scenario supporting the initiatives delivering the European Green Deal. Projections consider, where available, the impact of both existing and additional policies and measures. (4) Target years to achieve climate neutrality as in the NECP progress reports or, with an asterisk "**", when from other unofficial sources ([Net Zero Tracker](#)).

The Climate-Neutrality Dashboard also includes a set of seven complementary indicators, or levers, to put some light into the level of GHG emissions in Member States.

Table 8: Climate neutrality levers

Climate-Neutrality Levers	EU-27	Malta	Change compared to 2024 for MT	Description
Zero-Emission Energy	57%	12%	●	Share of RES and nuclear in gross electricity and heat production
Greening Industry	44%	74%	●	Share of RES and electricity in FEC in manufacturing and construction
Sustainable mobility	122	110	●	Average CO ₂ emissions of new cars sold
Energy efficient buildings	11.6	30.7	●	FEC in buildings, gOE per m ² *heating and cooling degree days
Waste prevention	517	635	●	Municipal waste generation per capita, kg.
Climate investment	0.6%	0.4%	●	Private Investment in climate change mitigation purposes, % of GDP
Sustainable consumption	14.1	20.1	●	Bovine meat consumption per capita, kg.

9. Financing climate action

Figure 19: National expenditure on environmental protection (2019-2022 average, % of GDP)

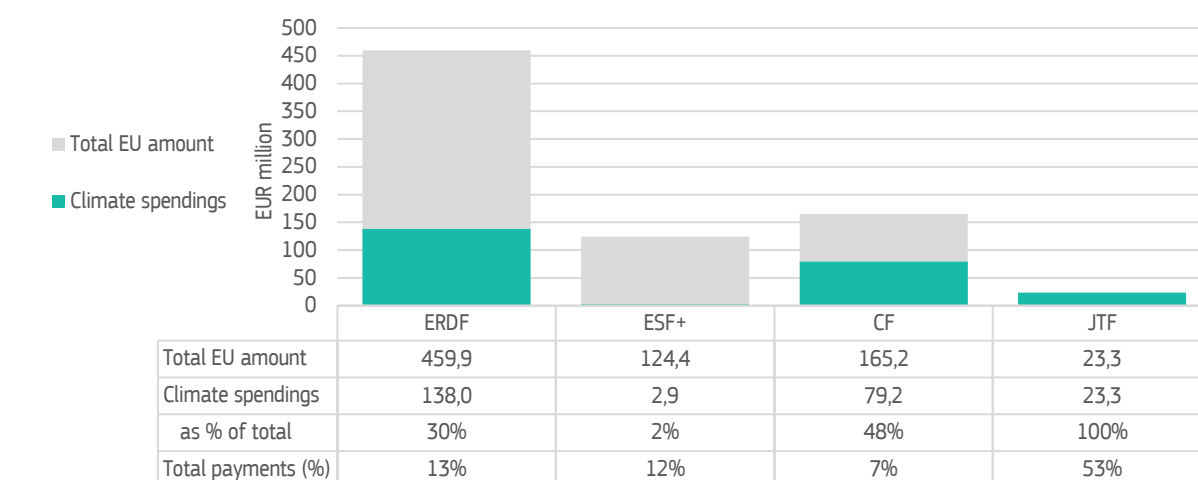


Source: Eurostat - [National expenditure on environmental protection by institutional sector](#).

Cohesion policy

Cohesion policy		
Climate spendings	Malta	EU-27
% total allocation	31%	32%

Figure 20: Climate spendings in cohesion policy funds



Notes: The chart presents information on investment plans from adopted programmes in 2021-2027 period. It shows only EU contribution. Payments include pre-financing and interim payments. Data update: 05/01/2026. Source: [Cohesion Open Data Platform](#)

Table 9: Project examples funded by cohesion policy 2014-2020

Category	Project	EU support
Transport	Sustainable transport hubs across Malta and Gozo	EUR 28.4 million
Adaptation	Monitoring and public engagement for improved water management	EUR 18.0 million
Buildings	Promotion of RES in households (2016-2018)	EUR 11.5 million
Adaptation	Rain Water Integrated Infrastructure Network - Phase 1	EUR 1.6 million

Source: [Inforegio - Projects](#)

Recovery and resilience facility

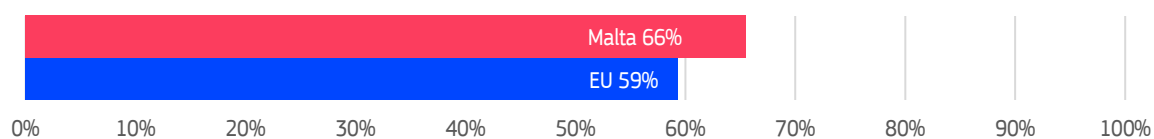
Table 10: Recovery and resilience facility allocation

RRF allocations (EUR billion)	Grants	Loans	% of GDP
	0.3	0.0	1%

Table 11: Climate spendings in Recovery and Resilience Facility

RRF for climate (EUR billion)	Expected climate spending	% of total RRF allocation
	0.2	62%
	<i>EU total climate spendings:</i>	<i>42%</i>

Note: Expected climate spendings based on climate tracking.

Figure 19: Total payments

Note: Disbursement reflects progress in the implementation of the RRF, across the six policy pillars. Data update: 05/01/2026.

Source: [Recovery and Resilience Scoreboard](#)

Innovation Fund

Table 12: Innovation Fund – portfolio of signed projects

Type of project	n.	EUR million
Small-scale projects	0	0.0
Large-scale projects	0	0.0
Net Zero Technologies	0	0.0
Batteries	0	0.0
Auction projects	0	0.0

Source: [Innovation Fund Project Portfolio](#)

Modernisation Fund

Malta is not eligible for the support.

This country profile supports and complement the assessments of the Climate Action Progress Report 2025. It is based on data reported by the EU Member States. It does not replace formal progress assessments.

Every year, the European Commission publishes the EU Climate Action Progress Report: an annual report on progress towards the EU's emission reduction targets. The report covers actual (historic) emissions and projected future emissions for the EU as a whole and for every EU Member State. It also includes information on different climate policy areas, EU legislative progress, climate finance and adaptation.

With the annual report, the Commission delivers on obligations set out in the [Governance Regulation](#), including to assess progress with the EU 2030 climate target.

You can see latest EU Climate Action Progress Report online: [Strengthening competitiveness on the road to climate neutrality](#).

The EU is proving that we can pursue ambitious climate action while strengthening our competitiveness and our independence. We are reducing emissions, creating jobs in future-proof industries, and giving businesses the confidence to invest and grow.

Today's Climate Action Progress Report confirms once again that we are on track to meet our 2030 climate target. Emissions in the EU continue to decline, with 2024 showing a decrease of 2.5% compared to 2023.

Climate neutrality is not just a slogan, it is also our commitment under the Paris Agreement. It provides strategic direction, offers clarity to our citizens and industries, and protects Europe from dangerous dependence on fossil fuels and unreliable partners.

Now, we must deliver. Every euro invested, every tonne of CO₂ avoided, and every partnership we forge brings us closer to a safer, cleaner and stronger Europe.

Wopke Hoekstra

Commissioner for Climate
Action European
Commission

